Tesco: price ladder first; needs create dedicated platforms

Value brands → Tesco → Finest structures the ladder; need-led ranges and functional platforms sit alongside it.

TESCO | GOOD FOOD BRIGHTER TOMORROWS

1. VALUE / ENTRY

Stockwell & Co.
Creamfields
Grower's Harvest
Ms Molly's / Hearty Food Co.

Category/value brands at the opening price end

2. EVERYDAY CORE

Tesco
Default brand across categories

Function stays mostly category-native

- **Dairy** → protein / gut health / reduction
- **Cereals** → fibre / wholegrain
- **Beverages** → sugar reduction / fortification
- **Snacks** → lighter claim use

3. PREMIUM

Tesco Finest
Taste, provenance, indulgence

Premium quality proposition

"Finest does not need functional claims because premium quality is the proposition."

4. NEED / VALUES

Free From
Organic
Plant Chef

Dietary or values-led need can override category

5. FUNCTIONAL PLATFORMS

High Protein
Gut Sense
Tesco Slim*

Mature benefits now work across categories

No Tesco-branded sports-performance line found

*weight-management adjacency

Most Tesco functionality still follows the food category — but protein and gut health are now developed enough to become cross-category destinations.

VALUE / ENTRY



Stockwell Sugar Free Lemonade

PREMIUM



Tesco Finest Burrata with Truffle

NEED / VALUES



Tesco Free From Stem Ginger Cookies



Tesco Organic Oats

FUNCTIONAL PLATFORMS



Tesco High Protein Strawberry Yogurt



Tesco Gut Sense Apple & Cinnamon Porridge Pot



Tesco High Protein Berry & Yogurt Granola

PRICE ORGANIZES THE PORTFOLIO. NEEDS CREATE THE BRANCHES. MATURE FUNCTIONS CAN BECOME DESTINATIONS.

Asda: price ladder first; needs create dedicated propositions

Just Essentials → Asda → Exceptional structures the ladder; need-led ranges and health platforms sit alongside it.

ASDA Live Better

1. VALUE / ENTRY

Just Essentials by Asda
Lowest-price essentials
Opening price tier

Price structures the ladder

2. EVERYDAY CORE

Asda
Default brand across categories

Function stays mostly category-native

- Dairy → protein / reduction / lactose-free
- Cereals → fibre / wholegrain / fortification
- Beverages → sugar reduction / fortification
- Snacks → lighter claim use

Live Better can overlay products

3. PREMIUM

Exceptional by Asda
Taste, ingredients, provenance

Premium quality proposition

"Exceptional does not need functional claims because premium quality is the proposition."

4. FUNCTION ACROSS TIERS

Live Better
The Health Menu by Asda
Health signposting can appear across the portfolio
Benefits become very explicit: protein, fibre, immune, muscle
No own-brand sports-performance line found

Function cuts across the tiers

5. SPECIALIZED SEGMENTS

Free From
Plant Based by Asda
OMV!
Dietary or lifestyle needs can override category
Plant Based = healthier everyday plant
OMV! = indulgent vegan

Mature needs become propositions

Most Asda functionality still follows the food category — but benefits are merchandised more explicity, and mature needs become named propositions.

PREMIUM



Exceptional Ugandan Dark Chocolate

SPECIALIZED SEGMENTS



Asda Free From Frosted Flakes



Plant Based by Asda Soya Unsweetened Drink



OMV! Cherry Bakewell Chunky Cookies

FUNCTION ACROSS TIERS



ASDA Chocolate Protein Granola



The Health Menu Zesty Mango, Pineapple & Ginger Smoothie Mix



The Health Menu Crunchy Mediterranean Style Nut & Pulse Shot

PRICE STRUCTURES THE RANGE. FUNCTION CUTS ACROSS IT. MATURE NEEDS BECOME PROPOSITIONS.

Sainsbury's: price is the main axis; function extends into specialist performance

Stamford Street Co. → Sainsbury's → Taste the Difference structures the value/quality ladder. Protein, fibre and gut health span everyday food, while Pro Fit takes function into dedicated sports nutrition.

Sainsbury's
Good food for all of us

VALUE / ENTRY

Stamford Street Co.

Opening-price essentials
Aldi Price Match frequently visible

Price structures the ladder

EVERYDAY CORE

Sainsbury's
Default brand across categories

Function stays mostly category-native

- Dairy → protein / reduction / gut health
- Cereals → fibre / wholegrain / fortification
- Beverages → fortification / sugar reduction
- Snacks → lighter claim use

Function can still surface across the ladder

PREMIUM

Taste the Difference
Taste, quality, provenance
Discovery extends the premium world
Premium quality proposition

"Taste the Difference does not need functional claims because premium quality is the proposition."

NEED / VALUES

Free From
SO Organic
Plant Pioneers

Dietary or values-led needs can override category
Organic and Free From remain clear transversal propositions

Mature needs become propositions

FUNCTION / PERFORMANCE

High Protein / Full on fibre
Gut health
Be Good To Yourself
Pro Fit

Benefits cut across the price architecture
From everyday function to specialist sports nutrition

Performance can become a destination

Functional benefits cut across the price ladder — and Sainsbury's pushes them further, from everyday protein and fibre signposting to gut health and own-label sports nutrition.

PREMIUM



Taste the Difference
Scottish Shortbread Fingers

NEED / VALUES



Free From Nacho Cheese
Tortilla Chips



SO Organic
Apple Juice

FUNCTION ACROSS TIERS



High Protein
Chocolate & Nut Granola



High Protein
Strawberry Yogurt



Gut Health
Plain Kefir Drink



Be Good To Yourself
Greek Style Salad Cheese

SPECIALIST PERFORMANCE



Pro Fit Protein Powder
Lean Vanilla

PRICE SETS THE TIERS. FUNCTION CUTS ACROSS THEM. PERFORMANCE CAN BECOME A SPECIALIST DESTINATION.

Food & Beverage Positioning Radar | Sainsbury's UK | portfolio architecture, claims and external verification

Morrisons: price is the main axis; health and provenance create specialist worlds

Savers → Morrisons → The Best structures value and quality. Healthier Living, Nourish and High Protein make function explicit, while Market Street adds a distinctive freshness and British-sourcing world.

Morrisons
Since 1899

1. VALUE / ENTRY

Morrisons Savers

Opening-price essentials
Unbeatable Price positioning

- ✓ Everyday staples
- ✓ Good quality, great value
- ✓ Wide range across categories

Price structures the ladder

2. EVERYDAY CORE

Morrisons
Since 1899

Default brand across categories
Function stays mostly category-native.

- Dairy → protein / reduction / lactose-free
- Cereals → fibre / wholegrain
- Beverages → sugar reduction / fortification
- Snacks → more fragmented claim use

Healthier Living can overlay qualifying products

Function can surface across the ladder

3. PREMIUM

Morrisons the Best

Taste, ingredients, provenance
Premium food experience

- ✓ High-quality ingredients
- ✓ Distinctive flavours
- ✓ Provenance and craft
- ✓ Indulgent food occasions

"The Best does not need functional claims because premium quality is the proposition."

4. SPECIALIZED WORLDS

Morrisons free from
PLANT REVOLUTION
SO ORGANIC
MARKET STREET

- ✓ Dietary, plant-based and provenance needs can override category
- ✓ Market Street = freshness / British sourcing / expertise

Strong needs create specialist worlds

5. FUNCTION / HEALTH

Healthier Living
High Protein / Protein
NOURISH

- ✓ Protein now crosses categories
- ✓ Nourish spans gut health, cholesterol and protein-led meals
- ✓ No Morrisons-owned sports-performance line found
- ✓ Applied Nutrition partnership is branded, not PL

Function becomes more explicit

Most function still follows the food — but Morrisons increasingly turns health into explicit navigation through Healthier Living, Nourish and cross-category protein.

PREMIUM



The Best Dominican Republic Dark Chocolate

NEED / VALUES



Free From Special Flakes



Unsweetened Soya Drink



Organic Semi Skimmed British Milk



Plant Revolution Chocolate Cupcakes

FUNCTION / HEALTH



Protein Strawberry Yogurt (20 g per pot)



Nourish Gut Health Orange & Mango Smoothie

CROSS-CATEGORY PROTEIN



Protein Chicken Fajita Pasta (32 g protein)

PRICE SETS THE TIERS. FUNCTION BECOMES MORE EXPLICIT. STRONG NEEDS CREATE SPECIALIST WORLDS.

Julia Lenc Follow for more insights

Waitrose: price is still the main axis, but from a higher quality baseline; health and values become architecture

Essential → Waitrose → No.1 moves from accessible quality to food-lover premium. Duchy Organic builds a strong values proposition, while Good Health, High Protein, Gut Health and 30+ Plants make health unusually structural.

WAITROSE & PARTNERS

1. EVERYDAY / ACCESSIBLE QUALITY

Essential Waitrose & Partners

Quality and value you'd expect from Waitrose at prices you wouldn't.

- ✓ Everyday staples
- ✓ High product standards
- ✓ Function can still appear
- ✓ Wide range across categories

Accessible quality sets the entry point

2. EVERYDAY CORE

WAITROSE & PARTNERS

Default brand across categories. Function mostly follows the food, supported by Good Health signposting.

- Dairy → protein / reduction
- Cereals → fibre / wholegrain
- Beverages → reduction / fortification
- Snacks → more fragmented claim use

Good Health signpost appears on **2,000+ products**

Everyday quality, with function where relevant

3. PREMIUM

N°1 WAITROSE & PARTNERS

For food lovers who put good food first.

- ✓ Exceptional ingredients
- ✓ Distinctive flavours
- ✓ Provenance and craft
- ✓ Indulgent food occasions

"No.1 does not need functional claims because premium quality is the proposition."

4. VALUES / LIFESTYLE

Duchy Organic — GOOD FOOD DOES GOOD

The UK's largest own-label organic food and drink brand.

free from — WAITROSE & PARTNERS

PlantLiving — WAITROSE & PARTNERS

- ✓ Organic, dietary and plant-based needs can override category
- ✓ Biodiversity, animal welfare and responsible sourcing (e.g. Duchy Organic)
- ✓ Wide range across food and drink

Values create distinctive shopping destinations

5. HEALTH / FUNCTION

GOOD HEALTH
Healthier choices across the portfolio (2,000+ products; 65% own-label sales target)

High Protein
Now across multiple categories, not just dairy

Gut Health
Dedicated range (e.g., kefir, shots, yogurts)

30+ Plants
Pioneering plant variety labelling (first UK supermarket) across meals, snacks and more

Function becomes a strategic pillar

EXAMPLES ACROSS THE ARCHITECTURE

EXSENTIAL



Essential Cranberry Juice Drink
(No added sugar)

PREMIUM (No.1)



No.1 Dominican Republic Dark Chocolate
(65% cocoa)

ORGANIC / VALUES



Duchy Organic
All Butter Shortbread Fingers

FREE FROM



Free From Triple Chocolate Cookies
(Gluten Free)

EVERYDAY CORE (PLANT)



Waitrose Unsweetened Soya Drink
(Vegan, source of calcium)

GUT HEALTH



Gut Health
Natural Kefir Drink

HIGH PROTEIN



High Protein Penne Rigate
(19 g protein per serving)

30+ PLANTS



Protein Boost **Savoury Mix**
(30+ plant varieties)

UK Private Label vs UK Market Median: Protein

Across cereals, snacks and beverages, retailer private-label portfolios are broadly market-like. Dairy looks higher on protein, but this is mainly a cheese-heavy assortment effect rather than portfolio-wide reformulation.

BETTER FOOD INSIGHTS BRIGHTER TOMORROWS

Median protein by category

All values are median protein in g/100 g or ml.

Retailer	Dairy	Cereals	Snacks	Beverages
UK median	**5.5**	**10.0**	**6.2**	**0.1**
Tesco	9.1	9.1	6.0	0.1
Asda	7.8	9.8	6.3	0.5
Sainsbury's	7.6	9.7	6.1	0.5
Morrisons	7.0	9.0	6.1	0.2
Waitrose	10.0	10.5	6.2	0.5

Private Labels vs Market medians

1. **Cereals** are very close to the UK median across all five retailers; beverage differences are tiny in absolute terms because the category baseline is near zero.
2. **Snacks** are also broadly market-like across all five retailers.
3. **Dairy** appears higher on protein for all five retailers, but this is mainly a mix effect.

Why dairy looks higher*

Retailer	Cheese-like share of dairy rows	Dairy protein median excluding cheese-like rows
Tesco	47%	~3.5
Asda	48%	~3.6
Sainsbury's	49%	~3.6
Morrisons	43%	~3.6
Waitrose	47%	~3.6

Once cheese-like products are excluded, retailer dairy medians fall to roughly 3.5–3.6 g/100 g.

Main message: UK private label looks much more protein-forward on pack than in underlying whole-portfolio composition.

* Dairy medians are mix-sensitive. A product-name sanity check suggests ~43–49% of retailer dairy rows are cheese-like; excluding cheese lowers median protein from 7–10 g to ~3.5–3.6 g/100 g.
Higher dairy protein/fat mainly reflects a cheese-heavy assortment mix, not portfolio-wide reformulation. Broad portfolio comparison; treat as directional. Source: Open Food Facts-based retailer pulls and UK category benchmarks.

UK Private Label vs UK Market Median: Fibre

Despite much stronger **fibre communication** on pack, underlying private-label portfolios remain **broadly** market-like.
Cereals sit close to the UK median, while snacks are slightly below across all five **retailers.**

BETTER FOOD INSIGHTS BRIGHTER TOMORROWS

Median fibre by category

All values are median fibre in g/100 g or ml.

Retailer	Dairy	Cereals	Snacks	Beverages
UK median	**0.2**	**7.6**	**3.2**	**0.1**
Tesco	0.0	7.4	2.7	0.1
Asda	0.5	7.6	2.6	0.5
Sainsbury's	0.5	7.1	2.8	0.5
Morrisons	0.3	6.8	2.5	0.3
Waitrose	0.0	8.1	3.0	0.5

Private Labels vs Market medians

1. **Cereals** are broadly market-like on fibre.
2. **Snacks** are market-like to slightly below market.
3. Overall retailer portfolios are either similar to, or a litttle below, UK fibre medians.

Main message: UK private label looks more fibre-forward in communication than in underlying whole-portfolio composition.

Broad portfolio comparison; treat as directional. Values are medians per 100 g or ml. Open Food Facts coverage is imperfect but large enough for high-level comparison.
Source: Open Food Facts-based retailer pulls and UK category benchmarks.

What do claim-bearing private-label packs communicate?

Quality / origin / values remain highly visible; functional claims are important, but not universally dominant.

Among packs with at least one detected on-pack claim, % carrying each benefit territory. One pack can carry several territories, so columns do not sum to 100%. Top row shows claim incidence among all OCR/LLM-analyzed packs.

BENEFIT TERRITORY	TESCO	ASDA	SAINSBURY'S	MORRISONS	WAITROSE
Packs with ≥1 detected on-pack claim	**61%**	**68%**	**59%**	**80%**	**59%**
QUALITY / VALUES / ORIGIN					
Organic / natural	9%	9%	19%	9%	**34%**
Origin / provenance / quality	**30%**	16%	23%	27%	21%
Clean label / no-additives	11%	17%	4%	**26%**	1%
Plant-based / vegan	8%	**10%**	6%	**10%**	1%
Sustainability	0%	0%	**2%**	0%	1%
FUNCTIONAL — ADD / SUPPORT					
Protein	4%	**8%**	4%	3%	4%
Fibre / wholegrain	8%	12%	10%	5%	**14%**
Fortification	11%	**16%**	15%	5%	4%
Energy	9%	12%	12%	**15%**	13%
Gut health	3%	2%	1%	2%	**6%**
Immune	0%	0%	0%	**1%**	0%
FUNCTIONAL — REDUCE / REMOVE					
Sugar / fat reduction	**19%**	17%	16%	12%	9%
Free-from (gluten / lactose / dairy)	11%	12%	**18%**	11%	6%

Food & Beverage Positioning Radar • UK mainstream retailers • OCR/LLM-detected on-pack positioning • claim incidence row = all analyzed packs; benefit rows = claim-bearing packs only

Like France, mainstream UK private label still communicates quality / origin / values broadly; function is more developed in selected ranges than universally dominant on pack.

UK private labels: disciplined followers, efficient executors

They are built around how shoppers actually buy — above all by price tier — not around isolated nutrient claims. That makes them exceptionally strong at scaling proven trends simply, logically and visibly.

1. THE PRODUCT ITSELF

Mostly market-like composition

- Protein and fibre stay close to category averages
- Higher dairy protein mainly reflects a cheese-heavy assortment mix
- Market parity is usually enough

Market-like composition

2. THE PORTFOLIO

Price is the main organizing axis

- Entry → everyday → premium structures all five retailers
- Waitrose follows the same logic from a higher-quality baseline
- Function and stronger needs layer onto the ladder

Price first, benefits layered

3. THE TREND STRATEGY

They scale proven needs into platforms

- Focus on large, scalable needs: protein, fibre, reduction, free-from, organic / natural, gut health
- They do not need to invent the trend
- Once demand is large enough, needs become ranges or platforms

Scale, then specialize

4. THE COMMUNICATION

Vocal, visible, simple

- Very vocal: ~60% of packs carry at least one claim
- Claims span quality, origin, organic, reduction, free-from and function
- When used, claims are blunt and unmistakable: HIGH PROTEIN • GUT HEALTH • HIGH IN FIBRE • NO ADDED SUGAR • FREE FROM

Market-like composition, unusually high claim density

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

Price and promotion are not a defence against private label.

If the PL product delivers comparable composition, sits in a clear price/quality ladder, addresses the same proven need and communicates it just as clearly, a branded product needs another reason to exist.

“HIGH PROTEIN is an entry ticket — not a proposition.”

Private label does not need to invent the trend. In the UK, it organizes it by price, scales it across the portfolio — and communicates it much more often.

Food & Beverage Positioning Radar (OCR/LLM positioning + OFF validation) • UK mainstream retailers • Sep 2026